ONE LAST PLATE

THE TABLE WE SET TOGETHER

We began by asking you to pull up a chair. Now, fifty states later, the plates are nearly cleared—and this is the part of the meal that has always mattered most.

Somewhere back at the start of this book, we said that food is how we remember where we've been. We hope, by now, that the idea has cooked all the way through. Because if you made even a handful of these dishes, you didn't just cross the country—you tasted it. You stood, for an evening, in a New Haven pizzeria and an Alabama backyard and a Lowcountry rice kitchen, and you carried a little of each of them home.

That was always the point. These recipes were never really about the food alone. They were about the hands that first made them, and the reasons those hands reached for what was near: the catfish in the river, the huckleberries on the mountainside, the hog that could not be wasted, the wheat that came across an ocean in someone's pocket. Every dish in this book is a small act of ingenuity and love, passed down until it landed, somehow, on your stove. You are the newest cook in a very long line.

And you've added something of your own now, too. A little too much pepper, maybe, or a substitution born of an empty cupboard, or the particular way your kitchen smells when the oven has been on all afternoon. That is how these dishes have always survived—not by staying the same, but by being made again, by someone new, in a place the last cook never imagined. The recipe on the page is only the beginning of the sentence. You finish it.

So keep this book somewhere it can get a little splattered. Lend it out. Argue with it. Make the cobbler for a birthday and the chowder for a cold night and the hot chicken for someone you're trying to impress. A country, in the end, is just a great many tables—and every time you set one, you make a little more room at it.

Thank you for pulling up a chair.
The plate is always yours to pass.

FROM OUR TABLE TO YOURS

MENUS FOR THE OCCASION

Fifty states make a long and happy table, but a good meal is rarely eaten one dish at a time. What follows are a few gatherings drawn from across the country—plates that were never neighbors by geography, but that sit down together beautifully all the same. Cook a whole menu, or borrow a single dish and build your own. There is no wrong way to set this table.

The Fourth of July

Smoke, char, and something cold and sweet to finish—the country's birthday, coast to coast.

- Grilled Chicken Sliders with Alabama White Sauce · *Alabama* 14
- Elk Burgers with Spicy Huckleberry BBQ Sauce · *Montana* 126
- Fried Green Tomatoes · *North Carolina* 154
- Cast-Iron Skillet Cornbread · *Oklahoma* 166
- Georgia Peach Cobbler · *Georgia* 52

A Sunday Supper

The slow, unhurried meal that anchors a week—a roast at the center and a pie to linger over.

- Wild Rice Soup · *Minnesota* 112
- Buffet-Style Prime Rib Roast with Pan Jus · *Nevada* 134
- Funeral Potatoes · *Utah* 198
- Apple Pie with Cheddar Cheese · *Vermont* 202

An East Coast Seaside Table

Everything the eastern U.S. coast gives up—briny, buttery, and best eaten with your sleeves pushed up. Choose one or two for a small meal, or serve all four when family and friends are joining.

- New England Clam Chowder · *Massachusetts* 104
- Steamed Crabs · *Maryland* 100
- Lobster Roll · *Maine* 96
- Key Lime Grilled Grouper and Coconut Rice · *Florida* 48

A Cozy Winter Table

For the short, cold days—deep pots, long simmers, and warmth that fills the whole kitchen. Only one of these will do.

- Burgoo · *Kentucky* 85
- Gumbo · *Louisiana* 92
- Knoephla Soup · *North Dakota* 158

A Weekend Breakfast

The meal worth waking up for, made slow—a griddle going and no one watching the clock.

- Denver Omelet · *Colorado* 36
- Scrapple Breakfast Sandwich · *Delaware* 44
- Buckwheat Pancakes · *West Virginia* 216
- Biscochitos · *New Mexico* 146

Game Day

Food built for a crowd and a couch—handheld, hearty, and happy to be shared.

- Philly Cheesesteak · *Pennsylvania* 174
- Chicago Dog · *Illinois* 66
- Cincinnati Chili · *Ohio* 162
- Chislic · *South Dakota* 186
- Kringle · *Wisconsin* 220

A Road-Trip Picnic

Wrapped, packed, and carried—the flavors of the open road, meant to be eaten somewhere with a view.

- Michigan-Style Cornish Pasty · *Michigan* 108
- Bierock · *Kansas* 80
- Fish Tacos · *California* 31
- Gooey Butter Cake · *Missouri* 121

COOK WITH CONFIDENCE

A GUIDE TO ALLERGENS

Every kitchen has someone to cook around—gluten to avoid, shellfish to steer clear of, a nut that can't come near the table. This guide sorts every dish in the book (sauces and sides are listed with the dish they serve) so you can find what fits, or see at a glance what to adjust. Where an allergen hides in a single, swappable ingredient, we've said so—because a good recipe should bend to the cook, not the other way around.

Free of All Major Allergens

No wheat, dairy, egg, shellfish, fish, peanut, tree nut, soy, or sesame in the recipe as written.

Kalua Pork · *Hawaii* 56
Corned Beef Boiled Dinner · *New Hampshire* 138
Chislic* · *South Dakota* 186

**Fried in vegetable oil, not peanut oil.*

Gluten-Free

Naturally, as written—always confirm broths, sauces, and seasoning blends carry no hidden wheat.

Akutaq · *Alaska* 18
Fried Catfish with Arkansas-Style Tartar Sauce · *Arkansas* 26
Denver Omelet · *Colorado* 36
Key Lime Grilled Grouper and Coconut Rice · *Florida* 48
Kalua Pork · *Hawaii* 56
Burgoo · *Kentucky* 85
Buffet-Style Prime Rib Roast with Pan Jus · *Nevada* 134
Corned Beef Boiled Dinner · *New Hampshire* 138
Johnnycakes · *Rhode Island* 178
Gullah Shrimp and Sausage Perloo · *South Carolina* 182
Chislic · *South Dakota* 186
Chili con Carne · *Texas* 194
Cedar-Planked Salmon with Honey-Balsamic Glaze · *Washington* 210
Cowboy Cutthroat Trout · *Wyoming* 224

Dairy-Free

Naturally, as written—some offer butter or cheese only as an optional finish, easily left out.

Grilled Chicken Sliders with Alabama White Sauce · *Alabama* 14
Akutaq · *Alaska* 18
Kalua Pork · *Hawaii* 56
Chicago Dog · *Illinois* 66
Burgoo · *Kentucky* 85
Gumbo · *Louisiana* 92
Steamed Crabs · *Maryland (skip the butter)* 100
Buffet-Style Prime Rib Roast with Pan Jus · *Nevada (use the oil)* 134
Corned Beef Boiled Dinner · *New Hampshire* 138
Cincinnati Chili · *Ohio (skip the cheese)* 162
Gullah Shrimp and Sausage Perloo · *South Carolina (use the oil)* 182
Chislic · *South Dakota* 186
Chili con Carne · *Texas* 194
Cedar-Planked Salmon with Honey-Balsamic Glaze · *Washington* 210
Cowboy Cutthroat Trout · *Wyoming (use the oil)* 224

RECIPES THAT CONTAIN

Contains Shellfish

Crab, clam, lobster, or shrimp—central to the dish and not removable.

White Clam Apizza · *Connecticut* 40
Gumbo · *Louisiana* 92
Lobster Roll · *Maine* 96
Steamed Crabs · *Maryland* 100
New England Clam Chowder · *Massachusetts* 104
Gullah Shrimp and Sausage Perloo · *South Carolina* 182

Contains Fish

The fish is the dish and cannot be removed.

Optional fish: Akutaq (leave out the flaked fish) · *Alaska* 18
Fried Catfish with Arkansas-Style Tartar Sauce · *Arkansas* 26
Fish Tacos · *California* 31
Key Lime Grilled Grouper and Coconut Rice · *Florida* 48

Cedar-Planked Salmon with Honey-Balsamic Glaze · *Washington* 210
Cowboy Cutthroat Trout · *Wyoming* 224

Contains Fish—Hidden Source

Fish is present only through Worcestershire sauce, which contains anchovy. A fish-free Worcestershire (or a splash of soy or coconut aminos) removes it.

Finger Steaks with Fry Sauce and French Fries · *Idaho* 61
Burgoo · *Kentucky* 85
Gumbo · *Louisiana* 92
Elk Burgers with Spicy Huckleberry BBQ Sauce · *Montana* 126
Cincinnati Chili · *Ohio* 162
Philly Cheesesteak · *Pennsylvania* 174
Peanut Soup · *Virginia* 206

Contains Eggs

Whole eggs, yolks, or egg-based mayonnaise. Some appear only as an egg wash or optional binder.

Grilled Chicken Sliders with Alabama White Sauce · *Alabama* 14
Fried Catfish with Arkansas-Style Tartar Sauce · *Arkansas* 26
Fish Tacos · *California* 31
Denver Omelet · *Colorado* 36
Scrapple Breakfast Sandwich · *Delaware* 44
Finger Steaks with Fry Sauce and French Fries · *Idaho* 61
Ham Balls with Sweet Sauce · *Iowa* 76
Bierock · *Kansas* 80
Lobster Roll · *Maine* 96
Michigan-Style Cornish Pasty · *Michigan* 108
Mississippi Mud Pie · *Mississippi* 116
Gooey Butter Cake · *Missouri* 121
Elk Burgers with Spicy Huckleberry BBQ Sauce · *Montana* 126
Cheese Frenchee · *Nebraska* 130
Pork Roll · *New Jersey* 142
Biscochitos · *New Mexico* 146
Fried Green Tomatoes · *North Carolina* 154
Knoephla Soup · *North Dakota* 158
Cast-Iron Skillet Cornbread · *Oklahoma* 166
Apple Pie with Cheddar Cheese · *Vermont* 202
Kringle · *Wisconsin* 220

Contains Peanuts

True peanuts—peanut butter and roasted peanuts—essential to the dish.

....Peanut Soup · *Virginia* 206

Contains Tree Nuts

Pecans or almonds. Coconut is no longer classed as a tree nut by the FDA, but some people with nut allergies avoid it, so the Florida coconut rice is listed here as well. In Mississippi and Wisconsin the nuts appear as a topping or flavoring that can often be omitted.

....Key Lime Grilled Grouper and Coconut Rice · *Florida* 48
....Mississippi Mud Pie · *Mississippi* 116
....Kringle · *Wisconsin* 220

Contains Soy

Present through tamari (a soy sauce), which can be swapped for coconut aminos.

....Cedar-Planked Salmon with Honey-Balsamic Glaze · *Washington* 210

A Note on Peanut Oil

These fried recipes list "vegetable or peanut oil." Refined peanut oil is generally considered safe for most peanut allergies, and each offers vegetable oil as an equal substitute. If in any doubt, choose the vegetable oil.

....Sonoran-Style Chimichanga · *Arizona* 22
....Fried Catfish with Arkansas-Style Tartar Sauce · *Arkansas* 26
....Fish Tacos · *California* 31
....Finger Steaks with Fry Sauce and French Fries · *Idaho* 61
....Cheese Frenchee · *Nebraska* 130
....Jo Jo Potatoes · *Oregon* 170
....Chislic · *South Dakota* 186
....Fried Chicken with Spicy Nashville Paste · *Tennessee* 190

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Burgoo · *Kentucky* 85
Cast-Iron Skillet Cornbread · *Oklahoma* 166
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Cheese Frenchee · *Nebraska* 130
Chicago Dog · *Illinois* 66
Chicken Riggies · *New York* 150
Chili con Carne · *Texas* 194
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Spicy Huckleberry BBQ Sauce · *Montana* 126
Steamed Crabs · *Maryland* 100
White Clam Apizza · *Connecticut* 40
Wild Rice Soup · *Minnesota* 112

MEET THE COOK

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Christina Reed believes the quickest way to know a place is to sit down at its table. Made in the USA: A Plate for Every State grew out of that belief—fifty states, fifty stories, and the dishes their people grow up with, argue over, and carry with them when they leave home.

She believes, too, that this country was never cooked from a single recipe. It grew from the people who were already here—who knew the rivers, the seasons, and the corn long before anyone else arrived—and from the people who crossed oceans and borders with seeds in their pockets and recipes in their memory, and made a new country a home of their own. Every one of those hands added something to the pot, and it is in that pot, shared and passed and made again, that we find what holds us together. One table. Many hands. A home for all of us.

She is also the author of *Souled Out*, a 52-week wellness journal that invites readers to check in with themselves one week at a time. The two books are close cousins. One asks what feeds the spirit; the other asks what feeds a family, a town, a state.

When she isn't writing, Christina is spending time with the people she loves—her friends, her family—and traveling the world, always curious about what is for dinner somewhere new. Home is Maryland, land of the newspaper-covered crab feast, where she lives with her husband.

There is always room at her table
for one more.